1 Arithmetic and Geometric Progressions

An arithmetic progression is defined by its starting term 'a_1' and unique common difference 'd'. A general AP can be written as a_1, a_2,..., a_n. Some useful results follow.

- Notice that the general AP can also be written as a_1, $a_1 + d$, $a_1 + 2d$,..., $a_1 + (n-1)d$.

$$a_n = a_1 + (n-1)d \tag{1}$$

- To sum the general AP, we can notice that the sum of the first and last terms is equal to the second and second-last terms and so on which is equal to $2a_1 + (n-1)d$ and we have $\frac{n}{2}$ pairs in the general AP.

$$S_n = \frac{n}{2}[2a_1 + (n-1)d] = \frac{n}{2}[a_1 + a_n] \tag{2}$$

A geometric progression is defined by its starting term 'u_1' and unique common ratio 'r'. A general GP can be written as u_1, u_2,..., u_n. Some useful results follow.

- Just like above, the general GP can be wriiten in a different way.

$$u_n = u_1 \cdot r^{n-1} \tag{3}$$

- To sum the general GP, we can shift the GP to the right and make its starting term u_2 by multiplying the entire GP by r. If we substract both these GPs we get a telescoping series.

$$S_n = u\left(\frac{1-r^n}{1-r}\right) = \frac{u_1 - u_n r}{1-r} \tag{4}$$

- Notice that if $|r| < 1$, the infinite sum seems to sum to a finite number. We can argue that as the value of n increases, the value of r^n decreases i.e. the limit r^n approaches as n goes to infinity is zero. None of the other terms in (4) care what the value of n is.

$$S_\infty = \frac{u}{1-r} \tag{5}$$

1. We can say three terms form an AP if $a_3 - a_2 = a_2 - a_1$. It comes out to be equal to the following term.

$$\frac{2\sqrt{b} - \sqrt{a} - \sqrt{c}}{2d}$$

Hence the new terms form an AP.

2. Notice that the sum can be written in an another way which gives us d in the denominator. This is a telescoping series where after simplification we end up with the following.

$$\frac{n-1}{\sqrt{a_1} + \sqrt{a_n}}$$

3. Same trick here. If we multiply with d, we get a telescoping series which after simplification gives us the following.

$$\frac{n-1}{a_1 a_n}$$

4. Follows from above. This telescoping series trick is only possible with the proposition that $a_1, a_2, ..., a_n$ are in an AP.

5. Let P(n) denote the sum given.

$$P(n) = \sum_{i=0}^{n} (-1)^i C_n^i a_{i+1} = 0$$

We know that $a_{i+1} = a_i + id$. So the sum can be written as follows.

$$\sum_{i=0}^{n} (-1)^i C_n^i [a_1 + id] = \sum_{i=0}^{n} (-1)^i C_n^i a_1 + \sum_{i=0}^{n} (-1)^i C_n^i id$$

From summation properties and absorption/subset identity ($k \cdot C_n^k = n \cdot C_{n-1}^{k-1}$) , we can simplify as follows.

$$a_1 \cdot \sum_{i=0}^{n} (-1)^i C_n^i + nid \cdot \sum_{i=1}^{n} (-1)^i C_{n-1}^{i-1}$$

By change of index from i to $k = i - 1$ in the second sum we can write the total sum as follows.

$$a_1 \cdot \sum_{i=0}^{n} (-1)^i C_n^i + nid \cdot \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} (-1)^{i+1} C_{n-1}^i = a_1 \cdot \sum_{i=0}^{n} (-1)^i C_n^i - nid \cdot \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} (-1)^i C_{n-1}^i$$

By invoking the binomial theorem, we get the following result

$$a_1 \cdot 0 - nid \cdot 0 = 0 = P(n)$$

Hence, the proposition P(n) is true for all $n \geq 2$ as $LHS = RHS$. Hence for any AP we have the equalities given by P(n).

6. Same trick as above using the following property $k(k-1)C_n^k = n(n-1)C_{n-2}^{k-2}$.

7. Solve this using the given equality $\frac{1}{logk} + \frac{1}{logn} = \frac{2}{logm}$ as well as logarithmic properties. Take the log of both sides and transfer $logn$ to the right and then show LHS = RHS.

8. You have to show that the ratio $\frac{S_n}{S_{kn}-S_n}$ is independent of n and you will find it to be equal to $\frac{1}{k^2-1}$.

9. Starting with the first equation, using some manipulation of terms we can show,

$$x_1 = \frac{a}{n} - \left(\frac{n-1}{2}\right) d$$

Then in the second equation using $a_n = a_1 + kd$, we find the following (assuming $k = n - 1$),

$$\sum (x + kd)^2 = x^2 \sum 1 + d^2 \sum k^2 + 2xd \sum k$$

Simplifying this using $\sum a^2 = \frac{n(n+1)(2n+1)}{6}$ and $\sum a = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}$ and banishing k from above,

$$nx^2 + d^2 \left(\frac{n(n-1)(2n-1)}{6}\right) + xdn(n-1)$$

Substituting the value of x_1 we found earlier and simplifying gives us the following,

$$d = \pm \frac{2}{n} \sqrt{\frac{3(nb^2 - a^2)}{n^2 - 1}}$$

10. The number sequence corresponds to starting term 3 and common difference 3 so the nth term is $3n$ and sum of first n terms is $\frac{3n(n+1)}{2}$.

11. We know that the square of an odd natural number is given by $(2n+1)^2$ where n is any whole number. Assume an AP 1,2,3,...,n where $a = 1, d = 1$. Then each row is given by the following relation,

$$S_{3n+1} - S_n$$

Simplifying this with the sum of general AP formula we get

$$S_{3n+1} - S_n = (2n+1)^2$$

12. Notice if we divide a_{m+n} by a_{m-n} we get,

$$r^{2n} = \frac{A}{B} \implies r = \left(\frac{A}{B}\right)^{\frac{1}{2n}}$$

Also notice that if we multiply a_{m+n} and a_{m-n} we get,

$$a_m = \sqrt{AB}$$

Let $a = \frac{A}{r^{m+n-1}}$ then we can write a_n as

$$a_n = \frac{A}{r^m} = A\left(\frac{B}{A}\right)^{\frac{m}{2n}}$$

13. Notice that the sum $S_{2n} - S_n = a_{n+1} + a_{n+2} + ... + a_{2n} = r^n(a_1 + a_2 + ... + a_n) = r^n S_n$ and similarly $S_{3n} - S_{2n} = r^{2n} Sn$. Hence

$$\frac{S_n}{S_{2n} - S_n} = \frac{S_{2n} - S_n}{S_{3n} - S_{2n}} = \frac{1}{r^n}$$

14. Using the sum formula of a general GP we find that,

$$S_n = \frac{u(1-r^n)}{1-r}, \bar{S}_n = \frac{r^{1-n}}{a}\left(\frac{r^n - 1}{r-1}\right) \implies \frac{S_n}{\bar{S}_n} = a^2 r^{n-1}$$

Using $\sum_0^n i = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}$ and rules of exponents we can conclude that,

$$\prod = a^n r^{\frac{n(n-1)}{2}}$$

By observation we can conclude that

$$\left(\prod\right)^2 = \left(\frac{S_n}{\bar{S}_n}\right)^n$$

15. Let S be the required sum. Multiply S with x. We have a partial telescoping series which gives us

$$S - xS = (1 + x + x^2 + ... + x^n) - (n + 1)x^{n+2}$$

After simplification and solving for S we get

$$S = \frac{1 - (n + 2)x^{n+1} - (n + 1)x^{n+2}}{(1 - x)^2}$$